GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

October 10th, 2025
Week 41
Volume 277, Issue 1206

Highlights:

Dramatic events.

- **Rotten times.**
- **HKC Fumble.**
- **Rich clueless man.**
- **India holds the fort.**
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QUOTE of the WEEK

"If you're not positive energy, you're negative energy."

– Marc Cuban

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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WHOANANZA?!

In ship recycling, where even a day can make an incredible difference (the summer of circa 2006 when India lost about USD 100/Ton overnight due to a collapse in steel prices, for example), a week can certainly make a dramatic difference especially given the turbulent nature of current times that global markets are enduring. Not only did the international markets ride through a rude awakening as a series of events and another proposed Peace Agreement in the Middle East between Hamas and Israel via the release of the **all** the hostages on the one hand, was met with the heads of states of Pakistan and the Taliban regime in Afghanistan pick up Russia's old bad habits in Ukraine as all nations reportedly engaged in aggressions pursuant to a collapse in prior peace talks.

This will certainly affect the future of shipping / trade in the region and in turn, feed through to the global ship recycling markets via incoming tonnage, as change certainly seems as though it's in the air this week.

Going through the checklist of key economic factors affecting the state of global ship recycling today, while the world awaits inflation reports from India and the U.S. (where the government is currently shut down), the Baltic Exchange Dry Index reported a marginal increase as it climbed a mere 13 points by close of Friday on the back of Capesize & Panamax indices both reporting a 13 and 34 point bump in their values, as the small vessel index fell to its lowest level since late August, resulting in the overall index still reporting a near 2% climb this week. Moreover, despite the rising trade rates, oil continues to take a hammering closing at a lowly USD 59.81 / barrel, a number that today stands 18% lower than the same time last year.

And tonnage, it sure seems as though it's coming given this week's result as both Indian and Bangladeshi waterfronts suddenly saw tonnage emerge at their respective anchorage horizons this week, especially in India - the nation most brutally hit by Trump's cluelessness over failing of Reagan-era policies of "strength through peace", where a 2025 rich man only knows how to dictate terms and temperament. Eroding fundamentals in the form of declining steel plate prices and fluctuating FTX values across the ship recycling board continue to see weekly disagreements as levels in some locations continue to devolve without end, while others display false hopes via marginal weekly improvements that disappear in subsequent ones. Turkey at the far end remains fashionably late with no progress in volumes, other than the occasional private fixture making the rounds.

As week 41 of 2025 / week 2 of October passes, a spook and a whoa later, the market remains just as devolved and unpredictable as ever, with India still holding the lowest placed highest value market to go to.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 41 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

HKC COMA!

Interim inertia.

After nearly two full quarters of an HKC induced coma spent on the sidelines watching other markets acquire tonnage whilst Chattogram buyers scrambled to upgrade their facilities to HKC standards while concurrently watching their political economic state fall into disarray thanks to the inertia of the interim regime, signs of life seem to finally be emerging from local shores as several well-priced sales from existing cash buyer inventories (including one capesize bulker) were reportedly concluded to hungry local recyclers with empty plots and available credit facilities with their banks that has now helped them get active over these eerily quiet months.

Some sales finally.

Although it still is 4 months away, a degree of local momentum seems to be building ahead of the upcoming elections scheduled for February 2026, as this inexperienced and clearly inactive regime looks destined to be ousted with a potential return of the opposition BNP frontrunner - Tarique Rahman - who reportedly spent about two decades overseas. Until such time, the Bangladesh economy seems destined to traverse through its share of brewing local tumult and this destination will limp through the occasional high priced fixture(s) on the occasional large LDT unit that may sporadically appear on the scenes, especially as both the Taka and local steel plate prices have been in on the sentiment shaking wagon, week after week.

Election hopes.

And this week was certainly no different as not only did the Taka fall 12 basis points to end it at BDT 121.55 against the U.S. Dollar, the industry has also kept one eye on local steel plate prices of the market leaders (where offers are concerned, provided you see one tabled) and has remained suspended at USD 519/ton, a USD 100/ton lower than Pakistan. However, as mentioned in the weekly, that was last week and the difference is (marginally) smaller now.

As such, despite gloomy post monsoon clouds that are still floating over the local ship recycling seascape, Chattogram does seem to be going through a potential upturn in vessel offerings as demand from dormant yards finally starts to tell and most recycling chop shops in Bangladesh are keeping an eye out on the upcoming elections as a potential turning point for their market.

Staggering uncertainty

A staggeringly uncertain time for this market lies ahead in the interim.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

FUNDAMENTALS FLOUNDER!

Miserable weeks.

The Indian market has, and continues to endure the most miserable of times of all global ship recycling destinations as the ongoing Trumpian saga of knee-jerking into global economic crises has sunk this market to the bottom of the ship recycling pricing board, with most Alang recyclers now opting to remain completely quiet, fearful of further market declines or what Jack-in-the-Box uncertainty this White House administration might just spook them around the next turn with, given that Indian fundamentals have been clearly floundering over the recent past.

Rs. 90?

While local steel prices have lost over USD 34/LDT over the last 3 weeks alone and managed to fall another catastrophic USD 7/Ton (down from the high of USD 424/Ton end of September to USD 391.21/Ton this week), severely undermining the viability of tabled offer levels and the safety of upcoming deliveries), the currency remains is the one that taking the local ship recycling community for the longest joy ride on shortest highway as it lost another 4-basis point against the U.S. Dollar and ended the week at a disastrous Rs. 88.75 – inching ever closer to the paranoia of hitting Rs. 89.

What's next? Rs. 90?

Torrid cycle.

If history can be a view into the future, this would turn out to be disastrous for the Indian ship recycling sector as the markets would certainly see the Alang end of the bidding tables vanish for the short term, which would spell trouble for recycling volumes given the spate of ongoing deliveries and units that have been arriving at Alang's shoreline over recent weeks (months perhaps?). On the flip side, owners of seriously old assets who have no other route for their vintage units than recycling, will probably see the worse end of the currency fluctuation / price index in comparison. Torrid cycle of events stands to unfold.

Coattails.

Until such time, India will continue to be the lowest priced market dominator of the ship recycling world as was clearly demonstrated by the voluminous number and total LDT of arrivals and beachings that exceeded 10 vessels hit nearly 120K LDT at the nations waterfront just this week. Alang's ride on the coattails of its HKC implementations until the Rupee crashes or competing neighbours' inch up on their HKC status, is likely to continue unimpeded despite its receding offerings – with owners and cash buyers chasing them down.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

WAR = 2 / HKC = 0

Truce hopes.

In the last 6 months, the state of Pakistan has managed to enter into its 2nd armed conflicts with its neighbors on both side, yet in even more time (8.5 months and counting just this year) and ever since the Pakistani government announced the adoption of the HKC, not a single yard has managed to attain its accreditation as yet. And while the Pakistani Air Force dropped bombs on alleged Taliban terror camps in Afghanistan, the real progress that the rest of the business world is waiting for, remains dreadfully out of site.

While provisional DASR approvals have kept local deliveries primed for survival until yards tidy and gear up to be fully accredited, the absence of news pertaining to potential international class authorities visiting Pakistan to confirm progress / issue certifications remain suspiciously amiss – granted not too many in the industry would be keen to visit an active war zone.

Global turmoil.

And as global markets continue to react negatively to Trump's chain reaction of ill-advised economic moves that are once again ratcheting up tariff threats against China (reportedly another 100% hike) and USTR (amongst another delayed U.S. tariffs) that come into effect, are leading to a host of Chinese reciprocal measures that stand to throw the shipping industry into disarray, should these tariffs come to pass. Pakistan's 30% tariff rate has also done little to ease the hot plastic summer slide that's been burning through Pakistan's inflation rate ever since they were announced back in August, with inflation nearly doubled over the last month.

Spicy.

Adding to the spiciness of the present is the perennial problem of trying to snag a juicy large LDT dry unit, which remains far from the interests of respective owners or cash buyers who are wary of moving large units to an HKC uncertain Pakistan. Moreover, with an utter lack of local arrivals (not a single fresh unit arrived this week and the only one at anchorage is a problem child from September), domestic steel mills have reportedly resorted to sourcing competing steel product from Iran resulting in the otherwise rock steady local steel plate price tumbling about USD 3/Ton and down to USD 616.80/Ton by the time the week ended. The PKR wasn't enjoying much of a "Prom Queen" moment either, losing about 18 basis points against the U.S. Dollar as the week ended and closed it out at PKR 283.20)

Uncertainty index.

Overall, Pakistan's uncertainty index seems shakier than Bangladesh's and this remains clearly evident from the local mood and resulting number of deliveries week after week. Short term forecast? This is a market where you could go big or go home.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

JUST KEEP GOING!

Strugglingly and ironic.

Like the jingle from "Finding Nemo", the Lira "just keeps going" down and down as it lost another 30 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and slumped even lower to end the week at a disastrous and record-breaking TRY 41.82. And while this has still not been the "INR 90" moment for the Lira (given that local recyclers are expecting to see levels cross TRY 50), the proportionate drop in local offerings in comparison to those from India, remain far more stable.

Yet, at what cost? When tonnage during these weakening financial times is certainly heading towards sub-continent shores vs. engaging with EUSRR rules and regulations. Struggling, yet ironic times indeed.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 41 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	**Improving**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	390 / LDT	410 / LDT	420 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *Sloths can hold their breath longer than dolphins. Dolphins must come to the surface almost every 10 minutes, but sloths can hold their breath for 20 minutes or more by slowing down their heart rates.*
- *Before toiler paper, corn cobs were used as a method of wiping. (EW!)*
- *This one might unsettle you, but snails have teeth. Snails can have up to 1,000 to 12,000 teeth. I don't know what they need those for, but good for them! I hope they have snail dentists, then.*
- *While she was a teenager during World War II, Queen Elizabeth II became a junior officer in the Auxiliary Territorial Service and became a trained mechanic.*
- *The real name of a hashtag is actually octothorpe.*
- *Due to the anatomy of their neck muscles and spine, pigs cannot look up to the sky. Imagine being a pig and never knowing that there is a whole world above you. BRB, gonna cry for a sec.*
- *For most people, it's impossible to lick their elbows. (Go ahead, try it.).*
- *A French general gave John Quincy Adams an alligator as a gift. The gator was kept in one of the White House's bathtubs.*
- *Ostriches have bigger eyes than they do brains. In fact, among all land animals, ostriches have the biggest eyes.*
- *A dentist invented the electric chair as a method for execution. Simply put, I'm glad I wasn't his patient.*
- *Like fingerprints, human tongues also have unique tongueprints.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 03 – Durga Puja October 22 – Diwali	October 05 – October 13 October 20 – October 26

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 01 & 02 – Durga Puja	October 06 – October 09 October 20 – October 23

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
October 24 – Founding Day	October 28 & 29 – Republic Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of October 10, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	AE Gas	2,222	LPG	Arrived October 07
2	*Ali S*	*4,869*	*Buk Carrier*	*Delivered October 04*
3	*Bow Cedar*	*11,043*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered October 09*
4	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
5	Jamal	31,326	LNG carrier	Arrived October 10
6	Josh (Under Tow)	15,415	Pipe Laying	Arrived October 10
7	*Lady L*	*5,827*	*Reefer*	*Delivered October 08*
8	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
9	*Shaurya II*	*15,810*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered October 09*
10	*Trut*	*2,700*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered October 01*
11	Vertex	1,087	Oil tanker	Arrived October 07
Total Tonnage		**119,924**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 09, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Asian Enterperise*	*9,016*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered October 09*
2	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
3	Nigata Trader	4,809	Container	Arrived August 09
		21,634		

GADANI - Port Position as of October 09, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Eena 1	1,444	General Cargo	Arrived September 27
Total Tonnage		**1,444**		

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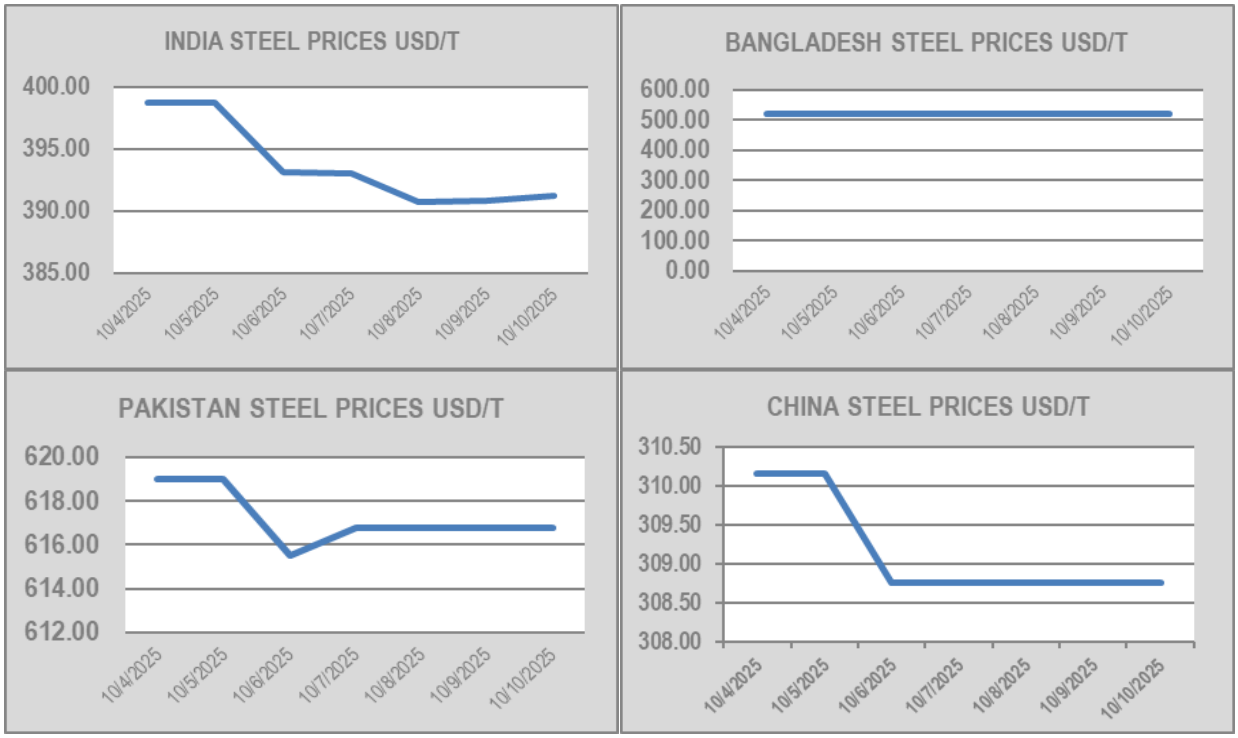
Steel Plate Prices

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/4/2025	398.74	35,400.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
10/5/2025	398.74	35,400.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
10/6/2025	393.11	34,900.00	615.49	174,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	308.77
10/7/2025	393.06	34,900.00	616.80	174,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	308.77
10/8/2025	390.77	34,700.00	616.80	174,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	308.77
10/9/2025	390.85	34,700.00	616.80	174,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	308.77
10/10/2025	391.21	34,700.00	616.80	174,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	308.77



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